

October

23



Going fast

1970

US racing driver Gary Gabelich set a new land speed record of 1,001.667 kph (622.407 mph) in a special rocket-powered vehicle called *Blue Flame* at the Bonneville Salt Flats in Utah, USA.

Also on this day

1958 Fictional little blue people named the **Smurfs** first featured in the comic series *Johan and Peewit* by Belgian cartoonist Peyo.

1991 The **Paris Peace Agreements** were signed in France in an official declaration of peace marking the end of the decade-long Cambodian–Vietnamese War.



1944

Battle of Leyte Gulf

The largest naval battle of World War II began as Japan fought the Allied forces near the Philippine islands. Over the next four days, the Japanese navy was defeated, allowing the Allies to gain power in the Pacific Ocean.

Born this day

1940 **Edson Arantes do Nascimento**, Brazilian footballer. Popularly known as Pelé, he played for his country from the age of 16, and is considered the greatest footballer of all time.

Crossing the sea

2018

After nine years of construction, the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macau Bridge was opened by Chinese leader Xi Jinping. Spanning 55 km (34 miles), it is the world's longest sea bridge-tunnel system and connects the islands of Hong Kong to mainland China.

